

Unit Y303: English Government and the Church 1066–1216

This theme focuses on changes in government and the Church. Learners should consider the main developments in government and administration and the developing relationship between the Crown and the Church. Learners should consider how far, and for what reasons, this relationship changed. The strands identified below are not to be studied in isolation to each other.

Learners will be aware of the changes and developments in the government and Church in the reigns of William I, William II, Henry I, Stephen, Henry II, Richard I and John. However, they are not expected to demonstrate a detailed understanding of the specification content, except for the named in-depth studies, but are expected to know the main developments and turning points relevant to the theme.

Thematic Study: English Government and the Church 1066–1216	
Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
Main features of central government	The role and development of: the household, exchequer, chancery, justiciar and law courts; the role and power of the Crown, the nobility, the Church and administrative officials in central government; the impact of continental possessions of the Crown on government; the reasons for rebellion and its impact on government.
The organisation and administration of local government	The links between central and local government; the development of Common Law, including the contributions of Anglo-Saxon customary law, feudal law and those of Anglo-Norman and Angevin kings; the maintenance of order in the localities.
The government of the Church in England	The role of the Archbishop of Canterbury, his relationship with bishops and with the Archbishop of York, including the primacy dispute; the administration of Church law; administrative structures; the role of monasticism.
The role of the archbishops of Canterbury	Their relationship with the Crown and the Papacy; the impact of the Papal reform movement; the significance of archbishops, including Lanfranc, Anselm, Theobald, Becket and Langton.

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Depth Studies	Content Learners should be aware of debates surrounding the issues outlined for each in-depth topic:
The reign of Henry I	The personality of Henry I; developments in finance, justice and administration, including the Exchequer, the royal household, the development of bureaucracy, the office of justiciar, ‘men raised from the dust’; the idea of contractual kingship; the role of Roger of Salisbury; local justice and government; feudal obligations; the seizure of Normandy and rebellions; the role of Duke Robert; Henry I and Anselm; the issue of homage, the issue of free elections, reforms under Anselm; the primacy dispute; Henry I as guardian of the Church; Henry I and the Papacy.
The Civil War 1139–1154	Causes of rebellion and civil war, usurpation, the dismissal of Roger of Salisbury; extent of disturbances, finance of the war, administration of justice; Stephen’s relationship with the barons, the power and loyalty of the barons and earls, baronial coinage; the functioning of central government, the exchequer, coinage; Stephen and the Church; election and support of Theobald; Theobald and canon law; changing relations with the Papacy; the Church and civil war; the impact of monastic orders; settlement and the legacy of Stephen’s reign.
The reign of Richard I in England	Finances, taxation and royal customs, sale of offices; William Longchamp; government in the absence of Richard; the role of Hubert Walter; rebellion under John; the use of itinerant justices; Walter as Archbishop of Canterbury; local government, assizes, Forest Assize, Assize of Weights and Measures; Richard and the Church.